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YANKS IN 'EM OUT'

By Chic Feldman

Let's See Who's Dishonest in Baseball

Almost everywhere the headline from here has wandered since the New Year's Eve expression of skepticism (on Py Carlin's tenor party) regarding the complete honesty of baseball, the amazingly alike reaction has been "The ya think so?" Always the reply must be the same. "I may as think so, but the people who run baseball say it is so."

Whereupon it is necessary to rectify the case history of the allegation and explain that although the baseball people spend tens of thousands of dollars every year for a commendation, two league presidents and high-pressure prize-agent who peddle their holier-than-thou claim, and professions of integrity, they repeatedly plant the seed of suspicion in the minds of the multitude via city statements.

In the American League, for example, the envy (to use a polite term) of the success of the Yankees is such that the league's staunchest defenders, the umpires. Thus, such ridiculous assertions that most umps favor the Yankees, and give them the benefit of the close decisions.

Granting that you and I know this to be untrue, is there a record of Commissioner Ford Frick or President Will Harridge demanding evidence of wrong-doing from the accused or sentencing him to silence? The latter couldn't possibly be, because judging by developments last week after the Yankees indulged in a vast player trade with Kansas City City.

No sooner did the contents become public property when Hank Greenberg, the Cleveland, described Kansas City as a Yankee farm, which even if partly true would be a violation of baseball's law, and severely punishable. At Chicago, "Chuck" Comiskey was equally violently vehement. What both said, via inference, if not fact, was that something illegal took place, and if this be true, what's to prevent you and I from deciding that if crookedness or collusion is permitted off the field, what's to prevent it from seeping onto the diamond?

Certainly, we're living in the "Suspicious Age," when every prize fight is regarded as a pantomime (often correctly) and corruption has beset our college sports—namely basketball. So that if dangerous implications regarding the sanctity of baseball are permitted to go unheeded, it may not be long before the distrust is general. Whereupon no amount of preaching, and police work, would repair the morale damage.

Indeed, there's been too much name-calling, and if the magnates in their violent anti-Yankees tirades, must abuse each other, let it be confined to personalities rather than to generalities involving the reputation of the sport and the men who have honored it, the umpires. Too often the blue serge brigade is burdened with responsibilities apt to weary and confuse a Moser, such as the duty of deciding when a pitcher is throwing "bean balls" at the head of a batsman.

Art Gore, a fine, firm splitter, caught Don Newcombe low-bridging several batters in Chicago last Summer. He knew from experience that Big Newk is never that wild, and warned him that if he threw another close-one to a hitter, he'd be through for 10 days. Newk's reaction was "if they throw at me, I'll throw at them." Manager Walt Alton of the Dodgers settled it by yanking Newcombe although he had a 10-4 lead.

The president's office should have commended Gore for the alertness and command which may have averted a tragedy. One might ask "What price honesty?" when National League President Warren Giles failed to rehire Gore for the impending season.

Tunis Brings 'Info' From 'Orleans

It is, therefore, most imperative that baseball possess a brighter side and such admirable personages as Angelo "Tiny" Tunis, the Scrantonian from the Providence area who is about to begin his twelfth year as a club trainer.

"Tiny," unspurred by the rigors of his profession, and, thus as refreshing as he was the day Joe Reardon hired him to serve the Carbondale Pioneer Blue, skywayed up from New Orleans (his home for the past six years) en route to his newest assignment, Indianapolis, and a Tuesday party. He can hardly hide the joy of finally reaching Triple-A company, and being a single step away from the majors. If, and when, he gets to the top, Tunis hopes it is in the company of Elmiran Andy Cohen with whom he'll be working for the third season.

Even so, he'll always love New Orleans for the dainty wife it gave him plus the fact that it possesses the largest colony of ex-Miners found anywhere. Tunis had an up-to-the-minute report on every one of them plus Al Signaigo whom he met whenever the Pelicans visited Memphis.

So, he, "Tiny," and "Maf" Sanchez, head of a Memphis agency and is doing fine . . . doesn't have to worry about baseball too much . . . All Fats in the justice's supply business but the poor guy is diabetic and that isn't good for a man who likes to eat . . . George Strickland works at the Fairgrounds (hoss-racing) until it is time to report to Cleveland and "Ref" Lavigne is manager of a television shop . . . Hey, oh yes, he's working for the City of Memphis, and promised to visit Scranton soon.

Tunis' chief interest rested in Scranton's baseball future, and our lack of a ball park brought the information that "We'll be in the same fix soon. The Pelicans' stadium has been sold to a hotel firm, for October dismantling, and no one knows what the future will bring." Despite the interracial future Tunis is convinced, the colored ballplayer is coming to the Southern Association just as he's nearly everywhere.

Six Reasons Why Foytack Stayed

The disclosure by Tunis that he saw Paul Foytack last Spring, when the Petersburg pitcher pitched several innings of an exhibition game at N. O. brought the reminder that this was about the time "Bucky" Harris, lured by Foytack's lack of control, notified the front office, to take him away. There were six reasons the Tigers didn't do so, and all in view of Foytack's subsequent 15 American triumphs, were lucky ones.

Seems the three allowable options on Foytack were exhausted and Detroit therefore couldn't send him to a club of lower classification without subjecting the hard-firing right-hander to ballclub's waiver list, where any club could claim Foytack for \$10,000.

Six clubs expressed a desire to grab Foytack, and the Detroit hierarchy, already convinced by Jack Tighe, then a coach, and Shemondah's Ed Katalase, Foytack's discoverer, that he'd eventually find himself, accepted the half dozen claims as so many good reasons to retain the product of Scranton Tech.

This is the story behind the story of the successful termination of the eight-year climb of Foytack who passed up measurably bigger bonus offers from Boston, Cleveland, the Giants, Cincinnati and the Yankees to take \$400 of the Braves' wealth. Since to accept more would have kept Foytack on the Detroit bench whereas he desired to work and learn to be an athlete.

Suppose Foytack had been allowed to leave the majors last year? "I was ready," he confessed, "to go back to Thomsen's" and the most produce business of his Georgian baseball-to-law.